



VISITOR GUIDE · TRAVELLING RESPONSIBLY

Magnetic Island & Townsville

We can't wait to welcome you to Magnetic Island. A few simple things will help you explore it safely, and help protect its wildlife and fringing reefs.

FOUR THINGS TO KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

01 Observe koalas quietly — never disturb them

Magnetic Island has Northern Australia's largest wild koala colony, best seen on the Forts Walk. Clients must watch quietly from the track, keep their distance, and never touch or disturb the animals.

02 Don't feed any wildlife

Despite popular feeding spots, feeding rock-wallabies and other wildlife harms their health and behaviour. Please don't feed any animal on the island.

03 Travel car-free — use the ferry and bus

78% of the island is national park. The SeaLink ferry plus local bus network makes a low-impact visit easy and is the recommended approach.

04 Acknowledge Wulgurukaba Country

The island is Yunbenun to its Traditional Owners, the Wulgurukaba people. Use the traditional name, and we'd encourage you to engage with the island's deep Aboriginal history.

PLEASE TAKE EXTRA CARE

Marine stingers & sun. Stinger season (Nov–May) requires suits in the water, the tropical sun is intense year-round, and walking trails need water, sun protection and sturdy footwear. Some trails close in extreme heat.

EXPLORING MAGNETIC ISLAND RESPONSIBLY

ENCOURAGE

- + Acknowledge Wulgurukaba connection to Yunbenun
- + Observe koalas quietly from the track
- + Use the ferry and local bus network
- + Stay on marked walking trails
- + Use reef-safe sunscreen when snorkelling
- + Wear a stinger suit in season
- + Carry water and sun protection
- + Support local island conservation groups

ADVISE AGAINST

- Feed rock-wallabies or any wildlife
- Touch or disturb koalas
- Leave marked trails in the national park
- Touch or stand on fringing coral
- Litter on beaches or trails
- Remove plants, rocks or natural material
- Disturb shell middens or cultural sites
- Approach wildlife for photos

WULGURUKABA COUNTRY & YUNBENUN

Magnetic Island is Yunbenun, 'spirit of the cassowary', to the Wulgurukaba people, the 'canoe people', who have cared for it for thousands of years. In 2024 the Queensland Government proposed renaming the national park Yunbenun National Park in recognition of their custodianship.